



Language translators meet patients at the airport, arrange hotels and transport, accompany them through medical consultations, and remain on-call for everything

While many hospitals employ in-house interpreters, for medical tourism facilitators such as Vaidam, medical translators are indispensable. Gaurav Gangwani, a 25-year-old translator, is fluent in French. Gangwani handles patients for French-speaking West Africa nations: Congo, Cameroon, Guinea, Ivory Coast, and Senegal.

“We can’t detach from what’s happening with patients. If we detach ourselves, we will not be able to give a personal touch to the patients,” says Gangwani. “Some patients lose their patience if their stay extends in India. Some get angry. In such situations, we are advised to keep calm. We deal

with different kinds of patients,” he adds.

Buddhadev Dhara, 29, began his career at Gurugram’s Artemis Hospitals as an inpatient department associate and has spent the last three-and-a-half years working as a medical interpreter with Vaidam. For Dhara, the role extends beyond translation. “Patients are worried most of the time, but when they see us, they feel comforted,” he says. The job requires interpreters to pick up basic medical terminology so they can accurately convey complex clinical information. Most of the Bangla-speaking patients Dhara assists are seeking treat-

ment for cancer or undergoing orthopaedic surgeries. For them, a familiar language and a trusted face can make the experience feel less overwhelming.

Bangladesh contributes the largest share of medical tourists to India, with Chennai and Kolkata as the preferred destinations, while patients from Iraq primarily seek treatment in Delhi. “Patients from Oman favour Mumbai and Kochi, Yemenis prefer Pune and Bengaluru, and Sudanese and Somali patients mostly travel to Hyderabad,” says Pankaj Chandna, co-founder, Vaidam. **BT**

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